

A few disadvantages

- It becomes confusing, sometimes, when so many changes are made in the source code of an open source programming language, by different users. Ultimately, this leaves us wondering about the version of the code we are using. In the case of licensed programming languages, the changes are made by developers of the source code and they clearly notify the current version of the code.
- Open source programming languages can also be tough to take on if we are very new to a certain language. If someone has worked on some previous code and hasn't commented it, but has written some messy lines of code, it can be extremely confusing to unravel.
- It becomes difficult to find support for some open source programming languages if community users do not have a solution to your specific problem, whereas for licensed languages, the developers provide full-time support.

It's rather difficult to come to a definite conclusion on whether we need to opt for an open source programming language or a licensed option since both have a few advantages and disadvantages. Although there are some significant pros associated with open source programming languages, like allowing for complete customisation for whatever task we are trying to accomplish and also full access to the source code, we cannot disengage ourselves completely from using licensed programming languages, since these are also useful at times when we suffer from platform dependency or tool support

issues. Before taking the plunge, we need to consider the several factors we have discussed along with our requirements while choosing a specific programming language.

Additional information

The Open Source Initiative (OSI) is a non-profit organisation that promotes open source products by certifying them with the Open Source Software trademark.

Debian Free Software Guidelines (DFSG) is a set of guidelines initially designed as a set of commitments that Debian agreed to abide by, and this has been adopted by the free software community as the basis of the Open Source Definition. 

References

- <http://www.webopedia.com/>
- <http://www.wikipedia.org/>
- <http://lifehacker.com>
- <http://www.opensource.org/>

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